PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #78 · SUBSTANCE ABUSE

“I don’t hurt anybody else, so this is my choice and it is fine.”

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Where it often comes from

“I don’t hurt anybody else, so this is my choice and it is fine” can come from a real desire not to be a burden, or from a wish to keep this private. Sometimes it is also a way to end the conversation. You do not need a list of people you have harmed in order to be worth helping. Your own life matters. And lives are connected: the people who love you are affected even when you are careful, even when you cannot see it, even when you are trying not to hurt them. This is not a speech to make you feel like a destroyer. It is an invitation to let your life count, including to you. If you want help, call the SAMHSA National Helpline at 1-800-662-4357. Do not try to stop or withdraw on your own if that could make you sick. A doctor can help you do it safely, and a counselor can walk with you. Needing that help is not a failure.

What Scripture teaches

None of us lives to himself alone, and none of us dies to himself alone. That is a word about connection, not a verdict that you have ruined everyone. You can approach God with confidence for mercy. You are fearfully and wonderfully made, which means your life is not a private thing you are allowed to throw away because you think no one else is involved. Jesus sets people free. He invites the weary to rest. Scripture cares about you, not only about the question of whether someone else has caught you.

> *“For none of us lives to himself alone, and none of us dies to himself alone”* (Romans 14:7).

Also see

> “Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need” (Hebrews 4:16).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

> “So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed” (John 8:36).

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28).

Common self-statements

- It is my body and my business.
- Nobody else is affected.
- If they do not know, it does not count.
- I am not hurting them, so I should be left alone.
- Getting help would worry people, so hiding is kinder.
- I do not matter enough for this to be a problem.

Common logical errors

- Minimization: Deciding hidden use has no effect.
- All-or-nothing thinking: If you are not the worst story you have heard, no one is touched.
- Mind reading: Assuming the people who love you are fine because they have not said otherwise.
- Discounting the positive: Treating your own life as too small to be worth help.

Challenging questions

- Who loves me, and have I actually asked whether they are unaffected?
- Do I hide this because it hurts no one, or because I do not want them to worry?
- If a friend said their life did not matter as long as others seemed fine, what would I say?
- What would change if I believed I was worth a doctor's help?
- Who is one person I could stop hiding from?
- What does "none of us lives to himself alone" invite, without a list of damages?

Truth summary

> My life matters, to God and to people who love me. I can get help because I am worth caring for.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

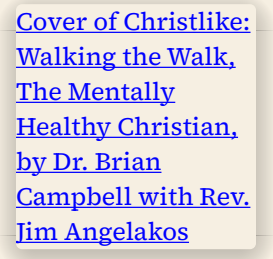
- Love, By God
- Friendship
- Help
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from "The Mentally Healthy Christian" (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
You are part of a body of people. Your life is connected, and you are still loved.

Love Take Me Over — Steven Curtis Chapman
Love can tell the truth and still stay.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Who you are to God is not "someone whose life does not matter as long as others seem fine."

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
Jesus loves you. That is a reason to get help, not a reason to hide.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I don't hurt anybody else, so this is my choice and it is fine."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I don't hurt anybody else, so this is my choice and it is fine." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who loves me, and have I actually asked whether they are unaffected?
- ☐ Do I hide this because it hurts no one, or because I do not want them to worry?
- ☐ If a friend said their life did not matter as long as others seemed fine, what would I say?
- ☐ What would change if I believed I was worth a doctor's help?
- ☐ Who is one person I could stop hiding from?
- ☐ What does "none of us lives to himself alone" invite, without a list of damages?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My life matters, to God and to people who love me. I can get help because I am worth caring for.
- ☐ I do not have to prove I have hurt someone before I deserve help.
- ☐ My life is connected to other lives.
- ☐ I matter even on the days I think I am only affecting myself.
- ☐ Jesus loves me. That is a reason to reach for help.
- ☐ I can be honest without calling myself a monster.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 14:7
  "For none of us lives to himself alone, and none of us dies to himself alone."
- ☐ Hebrews 4:16
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you said it hurt no one: Each day, write down one moment when you treated this as a private choice with no cost. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 14:7 becomes: "James can write: "I do not live to myself alone. My life matters, and I can ask for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Love, By God" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.

- [ ] Tell one person who loves you a single true sentence, or tell a counselor first if that person is not safe.
- [ ] Call 1-800-662-4357 if you do not yet have a person to tell. You do not have to have a crisis story.
- [ ] Ask a doctor for a safe plan before you stop. Your body matters too.
- [ ] Read Romans 14:7 as a word about connection, not as an accusation.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I don't hurt anybody else, so this is my choice and it is fine.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I let my life matter
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I don't hurt anybody else, so this is my choice and it is fine~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have said this hurts no one and so it is fine. Teach me that my life matters, and that the people who love me matter, and give me a safe way to get help. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.